bullock-carts were not allowed to move without a driver. A child could only drive a cart if accompanied by an adult. Reckless driving was punished except when the nose-string of the bullock broke accidentally or if the animal had panicked.

The *Arthashastra* also contains instructions for waste-disposal, building codes, the maintenance of public spaces like parks and rules against encroachment into a neighbour's property. We know that Kautilya did not approve of nosy neighbours as there is even a rule against interfering in the affairs of a neighbour. Very interestingly, there are specific injunctions against urinating and defecating in public spaces. The *Arthashastra* specifies fines for urinating or defecating near a water reservoir, a temple and a royal palace. One wonders why today's Indian cities do not enforce the ancient example.

The municipal laws specified in the *Arthashastra* clearly reflect a society that has a sophisticated understanding of urban life. Was this all relearned in the Iron Age or do they contain vestiges of the Harappan way of life? Of course, the majority of the people in the Mauryan empire lived in villages and Kautilya attaches a great deal of importance to agriculture, animal husbandry and land revenue. He also gives detailed instruction on the management of forests, especially those that supplied elephants. Summer was deemed a good time to catch elephants and twenty-year-olds were considered of the ideal age. At the same time, the capture of pregnant or suckling females and of cubs was strictly forbidden.

The establishment of the Mauryan empire appears to have created a stable environment that encouraged internal and external trade. There were major imperial highways crossing the country. The most important of these imperial highways extended from Taxila to the port of Tamralipti in Bengal. The Mauryans were merely formalizing the Uttara Path that had already existed for a thousand years. The Macedonian ambassador Megasthenes very likely used it to visit the imperial capital of Pataliputra. As discussed earlier, this highway survives as NH1 between Amritsar and Delhi and as NH2 between Delhi and Kolkata. During Mauryan times, the section